Dropbox, Google Drive, OneDrive

(Cloud storage and file sharing)

Cloud Storage??

Cloud storage is called so because:

1. Your data is stored on remote servers over the internet often referred to as “the cloud”, instead of being saved on your personal device.

2. This allows you to access your files anytime and from anywhere using any device with an internet connection.

3. Companies like Google, Microsoft, and Dropbox manage these servers securely, keeping your files safe, backed up, and easy to share or collaborate on.

Comparative Analysis

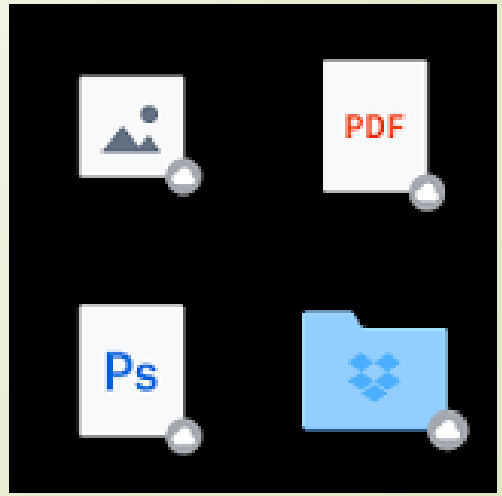
What is Dropbox used for?

- Dropbox is a home for all your work. You can store and share files, collaborate on projects, and bring your best ideas to life—whether you're working alone or with colleagues and clients. With Dropbox, all your files are backed up to the cloud and available online.



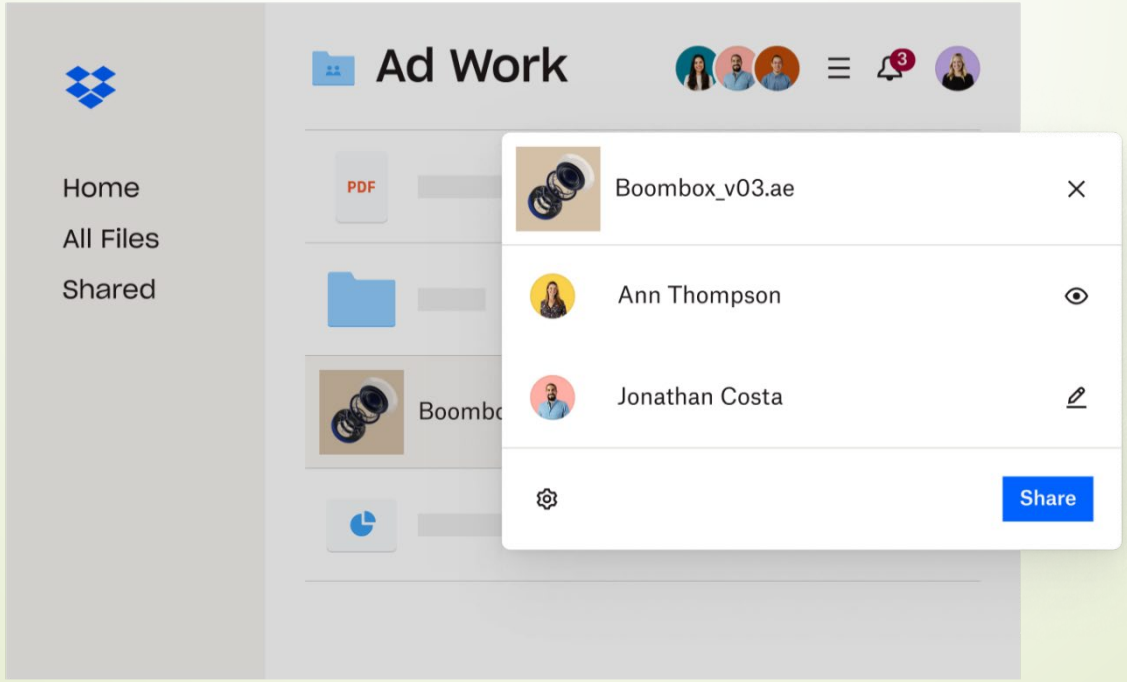
Dropbox cloud storage feature

- Store any file or folder
- Access your files from multiple devices
- Protect your data
- Recover your files
- Organize, browse and share photos from one safe space
- Get the right amount of storage space for you



Dropbox file sharing feature

- Sharing a Dropbox folder with anyone you want is easy. Create a shared link to the folder you want to share, and then send the shared link via email, chat, or text to whomever you like. Anyone with the link can view and download the content of the folder you've shared.



How does Dropbox work for sharing files?

- Log in to dropbox.com.
- Hover over the file or folder you'd like to share and click the share icon (rectangle with an up arrow).
- Type the Email, name, or group of the person (or people) you'd like to share with, and click to select them from the results. ...
- Select Can edit or Can view.

What is Google Drive?

- Google Drive is a cloud-based storage service that enables users to store and access files online. The service syncs stored documents, photos and more across all the user's devices, including mobile devices, tablets and PCs.
- Google Drive integrates with the company's other services and systems -- including Google Docs, Gmail, Android, Chrome, YouTube, Google Analytics and Google+. Google Drive competes with Microsoft OneDrive, Apple iCloud, Box, Dropbox and SugarSync.

How does Google Drive work?

- To get started with Google Drive, the user must create or sign in to a Google account. Then, the user types *drive.google.com* into their browser. My Drive will automatically appear, which can contain uploaded or synced files and folders, as well as Google Sheets, Google Slides and Google Docs files. Then, the user can either upload files from their computer or create files in Google Drive.

What are Google Docs, Google Slides and Google Sheets?

- Google Docs, Google Slides and Google Sheets make up Google Drive's office suite: Docs is a word processor, Slides is a presentation program, and Sheets is a spreadsheet program. Respectively, they can be compared to Microsoft Word, Microsoft PowerPoint and Microsoft Excel. Although the Google versions lack some capabilities that those Microsoft Office applications have, they are simple, collaborative and free.

Features of Google Drive

Pricing and storage tiers

- Google offers 15 gigabytes of storage for free and larger amounts at low rates -- 100 GB for $1.99 per month, 200 GB for $2.99 per month and 2 TB for $19.99 per month.

Consumer vs. enterprise use of Google Drive

- Google Drive for Work, offers unlimited storage, more management controls for IT administrators, application programming interfaces to connect to an organization's existing business applications and additional technical support from Google.

Features of Google Drive

Google Drive security

- Google Drive data is encrypted with the Transport Layer Security standard before it leaves a user's device and uploads to Google's cloud. The data is unencrypted and re-encrypted with 128-bit Advanced Encryption Standard (AES) when it reaches Google. The AES encryption keys are also encrypted, adding another layer of security. Google Drive supports two-factor authentication, and under the right conditions, it is compliant with the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act.

Microsoft OneDrive

- OneDrive allows users to save files, photos and other documents across multiple devices. A user can also save their files in OneDrive and have it automatically sync on other devices. This means someone can access and work on the same document in multiple locations. OneDrive provides relatively easy access to cloud storage space, allowing options to share content with others.



How it works

- It doesn't require a download and should already be a part of Windows 11. A Microsoft account is required to use One Drive and users will need to sign in before using it. To sign in, users will need to go to onedrive.com and select "Sign in" which appears at the top of the page.
- The system allows users to simultaneously edit Office documents, edit documents in browsers, and create and share folders. OneDrive also offers Facebook integration, automatic camera roll backup and the ability for users to email slide shows. Users can also scan documents and store them in OneDrive.

OneDrive

- OneDrive is also available on mobile platforms -- on Mac, iPhone and Android.
- Another feature, called Personal Vault, allows users to store important files with additional protection. Personal Vault allows users to access stored files only with a strong authentication method or adding another layer of identity verification. For example, biometric authentication, PIN, or a code sent to the user via email or SMS.

Price of OneDrive

- OneDrive comes with 5 GB of free storage. Users can add more storage space upgrading to a different home or business plans. The home plans include the free basic 5 GB plan, a $1.99 a month 100 GB plan, a $69.99 Microsoft 365 Personal plan with 1 TB of storage space or a $99.99 Microsoft 365 Family plan with 1 TB for six different users -- offering a total of six terabytes for that one plan.